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Research and update the rogueplanet report

Vulnerability Report

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TLP:CLEAR | Lost Boys Cyber | Research and update the rogueplanet report - Vulnerability Report

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1. Executive Summary

RoguePlanet is now formally tracked as `CVE-2026-50656`, a Microsoft Defender / Microsoft Malware Protection Engine elevation-of-privilege vulnerability publicly disclosed through the Nightmare Eclipse / Chaotic Eclipse proof-of-concept release on 2026-06-09 and acknowledged by Microsoft on 2026-06-16. Microsoft classifies the issue as Important and scores it `CVSS:3.1/AV:L/AC:L/PR:L/UI:N/S:U/C:H/I:H/A:H/E:F/RL:U/RC:C` with a base score of 7.8, functional exploit code maturity, public disclosure confirmed, and no confirmed exploitation in Microsoft's advisory data as of this report update. NVD also lists the issue as analyzed and high severity, but uses a more conservative NVD primary vector of `AV:L/AC:H/PR:L/UI:N/S:U/C:H/I:H/A:H` with a 7.0 base score, reflecting the race-condition reliability uncertainty.

The practical risk remains high for Windows endpoints because the public exploit can convert low-privilege local execution into `NT AUTHORITY\SYSTEM` when the race succeeds. Direct inspection of the public repository and publisher README supports a local privilege-escalation assessment against Windows 10 and Windows 11 systems, including fully patched June 2026 desktop builds. Microsoft's CSAF advisory identifies the weakness as `CWE-59: Improper Link Resolution Before File Access ('Link Following')`, which aligns with the PoC's abuse of Defender scan/remediation behavior, attacker-controlled path redirection, temporary artifacts, and reparse/junction-style manipulation.

Defenders should treat RoguePlanet as a public, functional post-foothold privilege-escalation capability rather than a theoretical vulnerability. The strongest current actions are to monitor for public-PoC artifacts, unexpected low-privilege-to-`SYSTEM` process transitions, mounted image staging, Defender remediation anomalies, and temp-path reparse behavior; to restrict untrusted code execution and non-admin ISO/VHD mounting where possible; and to track Microsoft Defender engine/platform updates until the CVE record reflects a resolved update path.

Executive Assessment	Judgment
Current identifier	`CVE-2026-50656` / RoguePlanet
Vendor / component	Microsoft Malware Protection Engine in Microsoft Defender
Current exploit form	Public local privilege-escalation PoC producing a `SYSTEM` shell when successful
Microsoft severity	Important; CVSS 7.8 High with functional exploit code maturity
NVD severity	High; CVSS 7.0 High with higher attack-complexity assessment
Confirmed exploitation	Microsoft CSAF: `Exploited:No`; CISA KEV catalog had no entry for `CVE-2026-50656` in the 2026-07-01 feed
Immediate defender priority	Hunt for PoC artifacts and privilege-escalation outcomes while reducing local code-execution and mounted-image abuse paths

2. Intelligence Requirement

This update answers the following requirement: what changed after Microsoft and NVD assigned `CVE-2026-50656` to RoguePlanet, how should defenders reconcile the public exploit with authoritative vendor scoring, and what immediate detection, hardening, and monitoring steps should Windows security teams take while update guidance remains fluid?

Question	Assessment
What changed since the initial RoguePlanet report?	Microsoft acknowledged the issue as `CVE-2026-50656`, mapped it to Microsoft Defender / Microsoft Malware Protection Engine, assigned `CWE-59`, scored it Important / CVSS 7.8, and marked functional exploit code available.
Is RoguePlanet local or remote?	The public June PoC is best supported as local privilege escalation. Historical researcher claims about earlier RCE-like and BitLocker-

	bypass-adjacent paths remain medium-confidence context, not the current validated exploit chain.
Is public exploit code available?	Yes. The public GitHub repository remains accessible and had approximately 1,479 stars and 592 forks in the GitHub API snapshot reviewed on 2026-07-02, indicating broad public visibility and reuse potential.
Has exploitation in the wild been confirmed?	Microsoft CSAF states `Exploited:No`; NVD includes CISA SSVS values of `exploitation:poc`, `automatable:no`, and `technicalImpact:total`; CISA KEV did not include the CVE in the 2026-07-01 catalog snapshot.
What remains uncertain?	Exact fixed Defender engine/platform versioning and final remediation timing remain unclear from the reviewed CSAF/NVD records. Server impact is still a researcher claim because the public PoC depends on user-mountable ISO behavior that standard server users typically lack.
What matters most to defenders?	Assume post-foothold actors can weaponize or modify the public code, monitor for Defender path-redirection behavior, and prioritize application control and image-mount restrictions on high-value Windows endpoints.

3. Source Review and Confidence

Source	Contribution	Confidence
Microsoft MSRC CSAF advisory for `CVE-2026-50656`	Authoritative vendor record: title, CVE, Important severity, `CWE-59`, CVSS 7.8 vector, public disclosure, functional exploit maturity, `Exploited:No`, and customer-action language.	High
NVD `CVE-2026-50656` API record	Independent vulnerability database record: analyzed status, Microsoft and NVD CVSS vectors, affected product CPE, CISA SSVS values, and references to MSRC and GitHub.	High
CISA KEV JSON catalog, version `2026.07.01`	Negative-evidence check: `CVE-2026-50656` was not present in the reviewed KEV feed.	High for KEV absence at review time
RoguePlanet GitHub README and repository metadata	Confirms public PoC availability, Windows 10/11 testing claims, race-condition reliability caveat, server limitation claim, repository creation/push timing, and high public attention.	High
Direct inspection of `RoguePlanet.cpp` from the published repository	Supports technical mechanics: Defender API loading, temp working directory, image-mount dependency, `wormgr.exe` artifact manipulation, named pipe usage, and `CreateProcessAsUser` / `conhost.exe` outcome.	High
Help Net Security, SecurityWeek,	Corroborate public disclosure timeline,	Medium

Malwarebytes, The Hacker News, and BleepingComputer reporting	MSRC acknowledgement, SYSTEM privilege outcome, and third-party validation commentary.	
Nightmare Eclipse blog post: `RoguePlanet, a quick history`	Primary-source narrative for earlier claimed SMB / `.vhd(x)` and BitLocker-bypass-adjacent behavior; useful for context but not independently validated as the current PoC path.	Medium

Overall confidence is high that RoguePlanet is a real Microsoft Defender elevation-of-privilege vulnerability with public exploit code and a vendor-assigned CVE. Confidence is high that the public exploit path should be treated as local privilege escalation. Confidence is lower on broader remote-code-execution or server exploitation claims because those claims rely mainly on the researcher's retrospective narrative and the current public PoC does not directly demonstrate those paths.

4. Key Findings

4.1. Vulnerability Metadata

Field	Value
Public name	RoguePlanet
CVE	`CVE-2026-50656`
Vendor title	Microsoft Defender Elevation of Privilege Vulnerability
Vendor / component	Microsoft Malware Protection Engine in Microsoft Defender
Weakness	`CWE-59: Improper Link Resolution Before File Access ('Link Following')`
Microsoft severity	Important; CVSS 7.8 High
Microsoft vector	`CVSS:3.1/AV:L/AC:L/PR:L/UI:N/S:U/C:H/I:H/A:H/E:F/RL:U/RC:C`
NVD primary vector	`CVSS:3.1/AV:L/AC:H/PR:L/UI:N/S:U/C:H/I:H/A:H` / 7.0 High
Attack vector	Local in the currently published PoC
Privileges required	Low
User interaction	None in CVSS terms once the attacker has local code execution
Exploit status	Publicly disclosed; functional exploit code; Microsoft states exploited in the wild: no
CISA SSVC in NVD	`exploitation:poc`, `automatable:no`, `technicalImpact:total`
Confirmed public platforms	Publisher-tested Windows 10 and Windows 11, including June 2026 patched desktop builds
Server status	Researcher claims server vulnerability, but the released PoC does not currently work on Windows Server due to ISO-mount constraints for standard users
Remediation status at update time	Microsoft states it is working to provide a high-quality security update and will update the CVE when available; organizations

should verify Defender engine/platform update guidance continuously

4.2. Technical Mechanics Supported by the Published PoC

Direct inspection of the public code and README supports the following findings about the released exploit path:

- The code dynamically loads Defender's `MpClient.dll`, opens Defender's management interface with `MpManagerOpen`, and triggers a targeted scan with `MpScanStart` against attacker-controlled file resources.
- The exploit creates a working directory under `%TEMP%\RP\_<GUID>` and manipulates a file path involving `wormgr.exe`, which becomes a prominent public-PoC artifact for file telemetry and retrospective hunting.
- The workflow relies on mounted image behavior and file/path redirection, including junction or reparse-point style manipulation, to influence Defender's privileged scan/remediation behavior.
- The code uses the named pipe `\\.\pipe\RoguePlanet` and an execution path involving `CreateProcessAsUser(..., L"C:\Windows\System32\conhost.exe", ...)` so that successful exploitation under `LOCAL SYSTEM` spawns an interactive console in the initiating user's session.
- The exploit is reliability-sensitive. The author describes it as "hit or miss," and NVD's primary CVSS assessment uses high attack complexity even though Microsoft's vendor vector uses low attack complexity and functional exploit maturity.

The central security issue is that a defensive product's privileged remediation flow can be made to cross a trust boundary. That makes RoguePlanet more consequential than a crash or local denial of service: it can convert an ordinary user foothold into full local system control.

4.3. Analyst Findings and Exposure Implications

Finding	Why It Matters
RoguePlanet now has a vendor CVE and authoritative vulnerability record.	The issue should move from watchlist-only handling into normal vulnerability-management tracking for Defender / Malware Protection Engine exposure.
The exploit is public and widely mirrored/forked.	Public source lowers the barrier for red teams, crimeware developers, and commodity malware operators to test, port, or improve the race.
Full system compromise is the expected successful impact.	`SYSTEM` execution enables credential theft, security-tool tampering, persistence, lateral-movement staging, and forensic destruction from a local foothold.
Exploitation has not been authoritatively confirmed in the reviewed vendor/CISA records.	The absence of confirmed exploitation lowers emergency-response certainty but does not reduce urgency created by functional public code.
The Microsoft/NVD attack-complexity difference is meaningful.	Reliability may vary by host state and timing, but a public race-condition exploit can improve quickly once defenders and attackers test variants.
Server exposure remains unresolved.	Teams should avoid declaring servers safe solely because the public PoC depends on desktop ISO-mount behavior.

4.4. MITRE ATT&CK Context

Tactic	Technique	Relevance
Privilege Escalation	`T1068` Exploitation for Privilege Escalation	Primary mapping: the public PoC turns low-privilege local execution into

		`SYSTEM`.
Defense Evasion / Privilege Escalation	`T1574` Hijack Execution Flow	Contextual mapping: the exploit manipulates path/link handling and privileged file access, though the stronger analytic framing is vulnerability exploitation.
Execution	`T1059` Command and Scripting Interpreter	Follow-on behavior may use `cmd.exe`, PowerShell, or other interpreters after SYSTEM access is obtained.
Initial Access / Execution	`T1204` User Execution	Relevant only if an attacker delivers a local payload through phishing or social engineering; not inherent to the CVE itself.
Defense Evasion	`T1562.001` Impair Defenses: Disable or Modify Tools	Plausible post-exploitation objective after SYSTEM access, especially because the vulnerable component is Defender.

5. Threat Context

RoguePlanet is part of a broader 2026 disclosure sequence involving Nightmare Eclipse / Chaotic Eclipse and Microsoft security bugs. Several public reports note that the researcher released multiple exploit proofs around Microsoft components after disputes with the vendor, and that some earlier Defender-related issues were later acknowledged and patched. That history matters because it argues against dismissing the report as noise, but it should not be used to overstate what the current public RoguePlanet PoC proves.

The authoritative record now confirms the core vulnerability class: an elevation-of-privilege issue in Microsoft Defender / Microsoft Malware Protection Engine with improper link resolution before file access. This aligns with the exploit's observable behavior: triggering Defender scanning, racing remediation/path handling, and redirecting Defender's privileged actions into attacker-controlled outcomes. The public code's desktop constraints and race reliability caveat are operational details, not a reason to disregard the vulnerability.

Threat Scenario	Assessment
Standard-user workstation foothold	Highest-confidence scenario. Phishing, commodity malware, malicious installers, or hands-on-keyboard access provide low-privilege execution; RoguePlanet attempts SYSTEM escalation.
Red-team and exploit-development reuse	High likelihood because the repository is public, concise, and already widely watched/forked.
Commodity malware integration	Plausible near-term risk if actors can improve reliability and remove obvious public-PoC artifacts.
Windows Server adaptation	Plausible but unproven. The researcher asserts server vulnerability, while the public PoC's ISO-mount dependency limits direct server execution.
Historical SMB / `.vhd(x)` coercion	Medium-confidence context only. Use it for watchlist coverage around mounted-image and remote-share activity, not as a validated current RCE chain.

The bottom line for defenders is simple: RoguePlanet is no longer just a same-day GitHub disclosure; it is a vendor-tracked high-severity Defender privilege-escalation vulnerability with functional public exploit code. Until remediation guidance is

clearly reflected in Microsoft Defender engine/platform update channels, security teams should assume that endpoints with low-privilege code-execution exposure remain at material risk.

6. Detection and Hunting

6.1. Detection Coverage Summary

Signal	Telemetry Source	Analytic Goal	Coverage Confidence
Creation of `%TEMP%\RP_*` working directories and suspicious temp-path `wormgr.exe` artifacts	Microsoft Defender for Endpoint `DeviceFileEvents`, Sysmon Event ID 11, EDR file telemetry	Detect direct use of the public PoC or minimally modified derivatives.	High for unmodified public PoC
Defender scan/remediation activity near attacker-writable directories, mounted images, or reparse points	Defender operational logs, MDE file/process telemetry, Sysmon file telemetry	Surface the vulnerability-abuse pivot where Defender interacts with attacker-controlled paths.	Medium
Image-mount activity involving `.iso`, `.vhd`, or `.vhdx` shortly before suspicious temp-path artifacts	EDR process/file telemetry, shell/explorer events, PowerShell logs	Detect staging compatible with the released PoC and historical researcher claims.	Medium
Unexpected `SYSTEM` execution of `conhost.exe`, `cmd.exe`, PowerShell, or other shells after user-context staging	MDE `DeviceProcessEvents`, Security 4688, Sysmon Event ID 1	Identify likely successful privilege-escalation outcomes.	Medium to High
Named pipe or command-line references to `RoguePlanet`	Sysmon pipe events where collected, EDR command-line telemetry	Catch public code or unclean derivatives that retain strings.	Medium for public code, low for refactored tooling

Analyst caveat: exact filenames and strings are likely to change. Treat these as starter detections for the public implementation and tune toward behavior chains: low-privilege staging, mounted image or link manipulation, Defender scan/remediation interaction, and rapid SYSTEM-level process creation.

6.2. Example Sigma Logic

```

title: Possible RoguePlanet-Style Temp Artifact and SYSTEM Console Escalation
id: 9e83f7ab-bf67-4c5f-b8e9-50656f00a001
status: experimental
description: Detects public RoguePlanet / CVE-2026-50656 style temp artifacts and suspicious SYSTEM console execution after user-writable temp activity.
references:
  - https://msrc.microsoft.com/update-guide/vulnerability/CVE-2026-50656
  - https://github.com/MSNightmare/RoguePlanet
author: Lost Boys Cyber
date: 2026-07-02
logsource:
  product: windows
  category: process_creation
detection:
  selection_system_console:
    User|contains: 'SYSTEM'
    Image|endswith:
      - '\\conhost.exe'
      - '\\cmd.exe'
      - '\\powershell.exe'
      - '\\pwsh.exe'
  selection_rogueplanet_context:
    CommandLine|contains:

```

```

- 'RoguePlanet'
- '\\AppData\\Local\\Temp\\RP_'
- '\\Temp\\RP_'
ParentCommandLine|contains:
- 'RoguePlanet'
- '\\AppData\\Local\\Temp\\RP_'
- '\\Temp\\RP_'
condition: selection_system_console and selection_rogueplanet_context
falsepositives:
- controlled security validation using the public PoC
- administrative troubleshooting tools launched from temporary directories
level: high
tags:
- attack.privilege_escalation
- attack.t1068

```

6.3. Example KQL Detections and Hunts

```

// RoguePlanet / CVE-2026-50656 public-PoC temp artifact hunt
DeviceFileEvents
| where Timestamp > ago(30d)
| where FolderPath has '\\AppData\\Local\\Temp\\RP_'
  or FolderPath has '\\Temp\\RP_'
  or (FileName =~ 'wermgr.exe' and FolderPath has '\\Temp\\')
| project Timestamp, DeviceName, ActionType, FileName, FolderPath,
  InitiatingProcessFileName, InitiatingProcessCommandLine, SHA1, SHA256
| order by Timestamp desc

// Suspicious low-privilege-to-SYSTEM console sequence after RoguePlanet-like staging
let staging = DeviceProcessEvents
| where Timestamp > ago(30d)
| where ProcessCommandLine has_any ('RoguePlanet', '\\AppData\\Local\\Temp\\RP_', '\\Temp\\RP_',
  '.iso', '.vhd', '.vhdx')
| project DeviceId, DeviceName, StagingTime=Timestamp, StagingUser=AccountName,
  StagingProcess=FileName, StagingCommand=ProcessCommandLine;
DeviceProcessEvents
| where Timestamp > ago(30d)
| where AccountName =~ 'SYSTEM'
| where FileName in~ ('conhost.exe', 'cmd.exe', 'powershell.exe', 'pwsh.exe')
| join kind=innerunique staging on DeviceId
| where Timestamp between (StagingTime .. StagingTime + 15m)
| project Timestamp, DeviceName, FileName, ProcessCommandLine,
  InitiatingProcessFileName, InitiatingProcessCommandLine,
  StagingTime, StagingUser, StagingProcess, StagingCommand
| order by Timestamp desc

// Mounted image and remote-share context hunt for RoguePlanet staging and historical variants
DeviceFileEvents
| where Timestamp > ago(30d)
| where FileName endswith '.iso'
  or FileName endswith '.vhd'
  or FileName endswith '.vhdx'
  or FolderPath startswith '\\\\'
| project Timestamp, DeviceName, ActionType, FileName, FolderPath,
  InitiatingProcessFileName, InitiatingProcessCommandLine, SHA1, SHA256
| order by Timestamp desc

// Defender-related process activity near suspicious temp paths
DeviceProcessEvents
| where Timestamp > ago(30d)
| where InitiatingProcessFileName in~ ('MsMpEng.exe', 'NisSrv.exe', 'MpCmdRun.exe')
  or FileName in~ ('MsMpEng.exe', 'NisSrv.exe', 'MpCmdRun.exe')
| where ProcessCommandLine has_any ('\\Temp\\RP_', 'wermgr.exe', '.iso', '.vhd', '.vhdx')
  or InitiatingProcessCommandLine has_any ('\\Temp\\RP_', 'wermgr.exe', '.iso', '.vhd', '.vhdx')
| project Timestamp, DeviceName, FileName, ProcessCommandLine,
  InitiatingProcessFileName, InitiatingProcessCommandLine, AccountName
| order by Timestamp desc

```

6.4. Hunt Hypotheses

- If RoguePlanet or a close derivative has been tested in the environment, there will be a short-lived cluster of temp-directory artifacts, mounted-image activity, Defender scan/remediation interactions, and unexpected `SYSTEM` process creation on the same endpoint.
- If an attacker modified public strings, the most durable signal will be a sequence relationship rather than a filename: low-privilege staging, path/link manipulation, Defender involvement, then privileged shell or payload execution.
- If historical SMB / `.vhd(x)` coercion variants are being explored, hosts may show remote-share access and mounted image operations before Defender-side file handling anomalies.
- If exploitation is integrated into commodity malware, post-escalation behavior may be louder than exploitation itself: token theft, LSASS access attempts, security-tool tampering, scheduled tasks, services, or persistence writes from a newly elevated context.

7. Recommendations

Priority	Owner	Recommendation	Defensive Outcome
Critical	Windows Platform / Endpoint Engineering	Track `CVE-2026-50656` in vulnerability management and verify Microsoft Defender engine/platform update status across Windows 10, Windows 11, and monitored server fleets.	Prevents stale assumptions now that a CVE and vendor advisory exist.
Critical	SOC / Detection Engineering	Deploy hunts for `%TEMP%\RP_*`, temp-path `wormgr.exe`, mounted image staging, Defender remediation anomalies, and unexpected `SYSTEM` console creation.	Improves detection of public-PoC use and early derivative testing.
High	Endpoint Security	Enforce WDAC, AppLocker, controlled folder access, or equivalent application-control policy on high-value Windows endpoints.	Reduces the low-privilege code-execution prerequisite attackers need before attempting the LPE.
High	Endpoint Security / IT Operations	Restrict or monitor non-admin ISO/VHD/VHDX mounting where business requirements allow.	Removes or increases the cost of a key public-PoC staging dependency.
High	Incident Response	Retrospectively review telemetry since 2026-06-09 for RoguePlanet artifacts and suspicious low-privilege-to-`SYSTEM` transitions.	Supports compromise assessment during the public-exploit window.
High	Vulnerability Management / Threat Intel	Monitor MSRC, Defender release notes, NVD, CISA KEV, and trusted security reporting for exploitation-status or remediation changes.	Keeps patch urgency and hunt logic aligned with the authoritative record.

Medium	Server / Workspace Owners	Keep Windows Server in watchlists even though the public PoC does not directly work there.	Avoids false confidence if alternate server-compatible exploit chains appear.
Medium	Security Awareness / IT Operations	Reduce opportunities for users to execute untrusted binaries or mount untrusted images from email, browser downloads, or remote shares.	Lowens the practical likelihood of exploit launch in user environments.

Additional analyst guidance:

- Treat Microsoft's `Exploited:No` and the missing CISA KEV entry as time-bounded status, not proof that the exploit will remain unused.
- Prefer behavior-chain detections over single strings because the public code is easy to edit and may quickly lose `RoguePlanet`, `%TEMP%\RP\_`, or `wormgr.exe` indicators.
- Reconcile Microsoft and NVD scoring differences in risk discussions: the race may be unreliable on some hosts, but successful exploitation has total confidentiality, integrity, and availability impact at local-system scope.
- If Microsoft later marks the CVE fixed through a Defender engine/platform release, verify actual engine versions on endpoints rather than assuming operating-system cumulative-update compliance is sufficient.

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